shocked at Sheinman's email, and wrote to students that Sheinman's "hurtful letter… contravene[s] the values of the university."

"Even this trivial expression of concern stirred such a backlash, and that's not trivial at all," Sheinman told me. "It actually tells you something important… to be shocked or angered, or allow yourself to be offended by a trivial expression of sympathy to everyone, is to betray a lack of such sympathy."

The peace camp

The "peace camp" had been withdrawing from the public sphere for years before the 2014 war. The violence of the Second Intifada led many Israelis to view the peaceniks as naive, and the years of quiet that followed took away any sense of urgency for reaching a deal with the Palestinians. Instead Netanyahu promoted "economic peace", the idea that Israel should marginally improve conditions for Palestinians in the West Bank without seriously trying to end the occupation. Gaza was an afterthought, an intractable problem that nobody wanted to deal with (including, to be fair, much of the Palestinian leadership).

The Israeli center-left shifted focus to economic issues. The summer of 2011 saw the largest demonstrations in Tel Aviv in two decades, which were focused not on peace but on prices. (They are somewhat jokingly known as the "cottage cheese protests", because the movement started with an angry Facebook post about the rising price of the popular dairy staple.) The protests started with a small tent city in HaBima Square in July. By September they had swelled to a mass movement, one that brought nearly half a million people into the streets. They were inspired, in part, by the pro-democracy protests sweeping the Arab world: their rallying cry, "the people demand social justice", had unmistakable echoes of the Arab Spring's most popular chant, "the people demand the downfall of the regime."

The anti-war protests in 2014 didn't even come close. The Israel Democracy Institute, a non-partisan think tank, carried out several surveys during the Gaza war. It found that, on average, 95 per cent of Israeli Jews thought the war was justified. By the end of the conflict, the air force alone had bombed Gaza some 5,000 times; fewer than 4 per cent of Israeli Jews thought this constituted excessive force, while more than a third thought the